



Discussion Guide: Patrick Reyes

Wanted: Dead or Alive

Reflect

- Patrick begins with the story of Hagar and Ishmael (Genesis 16, 21). Hagar is abused by Abraham and Sarah, evicted with little hope of survival, and forced to live as a refugee with her child. What stands out to you about this story? What do you find troubling?
- What parallels do you see between the story of Hagar and Ishmael and the experience of people of color (including immigrants and refugees) in America today?
- The name Ishmael means "God hears," and Hagar names God, El-roi, which means, "God who sees me." What do these names reveal about God's interests and concerns in this story? What might we learn from this story about who God hears and sees in our world today?

Respond

- Who has been influential in helping you feel welcomed, valued, and important as an individual? What difference has it made in your life?
- How can your faith community cultivate the practice of "seeing and hearing" those whose lives, gifts, and struggles may be overlooked by society? (This may take many forms such as worship, art, scriptural interpretation, activism, etc.)
- What does it look like to be "fully alive" in your family? Your vocation? Your neighborhood? What are some concrete ways you can be involved in the process of supporting others as they are called to life by God, especially in the midst of trauma and violence?